Sandeep Balakrishna, apart from the publications of the Ramakrishna Mission Institute of Culture and Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan. This was, of course, in addition to the writings of Swami Vivekananda, Sri Aurobindo and other civilisational icons. My reading was based on the recommendations of better-informed individuals who worked full-time on civilisational issues as trained scholars, historians, civil society advocates, educators and public intellectuals. Also, the diversity of my reading was handicapped by the unfortunate reality that I was more comfortable consuming content in English than in Indian languages, which represented the very problem I hoped to understand better.

On the constitutional front, I revisited the history starting from the Home Rule Scheme in 1889 until the adoption of the Constitution in an effort to better understand whether this document captured the essence of and reflected Bharat's civilisational spirit. B. Shiva Rao's six-volume publication *The Framing of India's Constitution: A Study*, V.P. Menon's *The Story of The Integration of the Indian States* and Justice Rama Jois's *Legal and Constitutional History of India: Ancient, Judicial and Constitutional System* served as some of my principal references in this regard. I also read through commentaries on Bharat's journey towards constitutionalism written between 1933 and the late 1940s, which shed light on the history and the prevalent thought processes on the subject. This exposure enabled me to apply the lessons drawn from the literature to live constitutional matters that had a bearing on the Indic civilisational worldview.

Among them, perhaps the most significant was the Sabarimala Sree Ayyappa Temple case which was taken up for hearings in July 2018 by a Constitution Bench of the Supreme Court headed by the then Chief Justice of India, Shri Dipak Misra. Fortunately, alongside several stalwarts of the profession, such as Senior Advocate Shri K. Parasaran, I was granted the opportunity by the Bench to present detailed arguments on behalf of People for Dharma and a Delhi-based women's organisation, Chetana, both of which supported the religious practices of the temple and its rights. This included its right to restrict the entry of women of the reproductive age group. Unfortunately, the Constitution Bench ruled in favour of the writ petitioners by a majority of 4–1 on 28 September 2018, against which several review petitions were moved. The review petitions were heard in early 2019, and later that year, acknowledging that the review petitions had merit, seven questions of law were framed by a Constitution Bench headed